

Northwind Cycling Club Member Handbook

Welcome to Northwind Cycling Club. The club was founded in 2011 in Kestrel Bay and runs group rides from April through October.

Membership tiers. A Standard membership costs \$85 per year. A Student membership costs \$40 per year and requires a valid student ID. A Family membership costs \$150 per year and covers up to four people living in the same household.

Renewals. Memberships must be renewed by March 31 each year. Members who renew after March 31 pay a \$15 reinstatement fee in addition to their membership price.

Group Ride Rules

Pace groups. Every ride is split into three pace groups. The Blue group is casual, averaging 18 to 22 km/h. The Green group is moderate, averaging 23 to 27 km/h. The Black group is fast, averaging 28 km/h or more.

Drop policy. Blue and Green are no-drop rides: the group waits for anyone who falls behind. Black is a drop ride, and riders who cannot hold the pace are expected to know their own way home.

Equipment. Helmets are mandatory on every ride; riders without a helmet will not be allowed to start. A working rear light is required for any ride that starts before 7:00 a.m.

Each group has a ride leader at the front and a designated sweep rider who stays at the back of the group.

Safety and Incidents

Incident reporting. Any crash, injury or near miss must be reported to the club safety officer within 48 hours using the online incident form.

First aid. Every ride leader carries a first-aid kit. At least one rider in each group should hold a current first-aid certificate.

Weather. Rides are cancelled if the temperature is below -5 degrees Celsius at the start time or if lightning is forecast. Cancellations are posted in the club group chat by 6:00 a.m. on the day of the ride.

Events and Volunteering

The Lakeshore Century. The club's signature event is a 160 km ride held on the second Saturday of September each year.

Volunteering. Every member must volunteer at least 4 hours per season, for example as a ride marshal or at a rest stop. Members who meet this requirement receive a 20% discount at the partner shop, Spoke & Gear.

Orientation. New members are invited to an orientation ride held on the first Sunday of every month during the riding season.